

And because the signal is spread over such a wide bandwidth, the risk of interference is low. This technology is also used for ground-penetrating radar devices.

Virtual Server

The part of a server that functions as if it were a separate, dedicated server. Each virtual server can run its own operating system and applications and even be networked with other virtual servers on the same machine. Web hosting companies use virtual servers to house multiple clients' Web sites on one server, for instance.

VPN

Virtual Private Network. A private network of computers that's at least partially connected by public phone lines. A good example would be a private office LAN that allows users to log in remotely over the Internet (an open, public system). VPNs use encryption and secure protocols such as PPTP to ensure that data transmissions are not intercepted by unauthorised parties.

WAN

Wide-Area Network. Take two LANs, hook them together, and you have a WAN. Wide-area networks can be made up of interconnected smaller networks spread throughout a building, a state, or the entire globe. The Internet could be considered a WAN. A wireless WAN is called a WWAN.

Warchalking

The unauthorised act of physically marking the locations of wireless access points (APs) that are available for free network access, such as those at a coffee house or an airport, or an office AP with a leaky signal. The word 'chalking' derives from the informal system of markings used by vagabonds to indicate places where one might get a meal or a place to sleep. See also wardriving.